

Introduction

The world as we know it changed on January 9, 2007 with the launch of the iPhone. It introduced and made touch interfaces the norm among smartphones, and smartphones a norm among mobile phones.

The already excellent functionality of the premium mobile device was further extended when Apple released the iPhone SDK on March 06, 2008 allowing developers to put their favourite and most profitable functionality on the iPhone. The iPhone apps made by any developer can be sold on the online app store by Apple where 70 per cent of the revenue from app sales goes to the developer and the remainder goes to Apple. This means big business, App Store is estimated to bring more than \$1 billion to Apple alone annually or approximately a lucrative market worth about Rs. 10,000 Crore for the developers. There are countries whose annual GDP is less than that.

The iPhone and its associated SDK made things a lot easy for mobile developers who were earlier plagued with the problem of fragmentation and a lack of single global distribution channel. With the iPhone SDK, a developer for the mobile platform can write an app that he is assured of running smoothly and in a desired fashion across millions of devices globally in circulation. In addition, revenue generation is far easier and hence motivated the development of polished professional applications for a mobile phone.

Today with over 50,000 apps in the App Store you can do anything on your iPhone from playing tetris to preliminary medical diagnoses and yes, this time you can even learn zen. The iPhone SDK has become an indispensable tool in the arsenal of any developer who is looking towards the mobile platform, which today every developer should. In India there are 10 mobile phones for every single desktop and laptop combined and there are more than quadruple the number of internet enabled mobile phones than a computer.

Writing applications for mobile phones is challenging given the limited processing power, memory, screen estate. iPhone makes it further